

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 8 5 2
♥ 5 4
♦ A Q 10 6
♣ 3 2

♠ K 7 3

♥ Q 10 6 2

♦ J 5

♣ J 8 7 4



♠ Q 9 6

♥ A 7 3

♦ K 4 3

♣ A 10 9 6

♠ A 4

♥ K J 9 8

♦ 9 8 7 2

♣ K Q 5

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♦

All Pass

2 ♥

2 ♥ by North

You dealt this hand.

With 13 points you will open. You cannot bid 1 ♥ with only 4 of them, so you say 1 ♦. Partner responds 1 ♥ and it is your bid again.

Partner's response is forcing. He might have anywhere from 6 points to about 17. With a minimum opener and 4-card support for his Major suit you bid 2 ♥. Partner passes.

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 8
 ♥ 8 7 5 3 2
 ♦ A 7 6 4
 ♣ J 8

♠ A Q J 5
 ♥ K J 4
 ♦ K 10 5 3
 ♣ 7 2



♠ K 10 4 3
 ♥ A 10
 ♦ Q 8
 ♣ K 10 5 4 3

♠ 7 6 2
 ♥ Q 9 6
 ♦ J 9 2
 ♣ A Q 9 6

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	1NT

All Pass

1NT by South

probably has something in ♣s since he has no 4-card Major and also didn't feel like supporting your ♦s.

So you pass and hope for the best.

You dealt this hand.

You are not strong enough to open 1NT, but too strong to pass. You bid 1♦. Partner responds 1NT. What do you say next?

You are not strong enough to open 1NT, but too strong to pass. You bid 1♦. Partner responds 1NT. What do you say next?

With that small doubleton in ♣s it is very tempting to rescue partner from 1NT by bidding 2♠. There are three good reasons why you don't. First, bidding 1♦ followed by 2♠ is a **REVERSE**, which shows a strong hand, perhaps 16-17 points or more. Second, and even more important, partner's 1NT bid **DENIES** a 4-card Major suit. And third, partner

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 4
♥ 10 9 4
♦ Q J 9 2
♣ 10 7 3

♠ 6 5 3

♥ K 8 7 2

♦ 8 7 3

♣ K Q 5



♠ J 10 2

♥ 6 3

♦ A K 10 6 4

♣ J 9 2

♠ A K 9 7

♥ A Q J 5

♦ 5

♣ A 8 6 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

1♥

Pass

1♣

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

You dealt this hand.

The ♥ and ♠ suits look really good, but neither of them are 5 cards, so you open 1♣. Partner responds 1♥. What is your next bid?

Partner's bid shows 6-10 points and at least 4♥s. Since you now know there is an 8-card Major suit fit you revalue your hand, adding 2 more points for the singleton ♦.

That gives you 20 points; add partner's 6-10 and you have enough for game. She who knows, goes, so you bid 4♥.

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 2
 ♥ K Q J 4 2
 ♦ J 10 3
 ♣ J 6 4

♠ A 10 9 7

♥ 7 5

♦ A K

♣ A 10 8 3 2



♠ Q 3

♥ 10 9 3

♦ Q 9 8 6 5

♣ K Q 7

♠ K 8 6 5 4

♥ A 8 6

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 9 5

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

You dealt this hand.

You have the right strength but the wrong distribution to open 1NT. So you bid 1 ♣. Partner responds 1 ♠. What do you say next?

With partner's ♠ bid giving you a fit, your hand revalues to 18 points. If partner has only 6 or 7 points there is not enough for game, but if he has more than that then you should bid game.

When you are in-between like this you just invite. So you jump to 3 ♠. This tells partner to bid game if he has more than the minimum for his bid. He has 9 revalued points, so he bids 4 ♠.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 4
♥ 2
♦ Q 8 3 2
♣ J 8 7 6 5 3

♠ Q 7 3
♥ K 10 3
♦ K 10 4
♣ A Q 10 2



♠ A 6 5 2
♥ A 8 7 5 4
♦ J 9 7
♣ 4

♠ K J 10 8
♥ Q J 9 6
♦ A 6 5
♣ K 9

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			

You dealt this hand.

This is the one situation when you open a 3-card ♦ suit; two 4-card Majors, three ♦s and two ♣s, but not enough strength to open 1NT.

Partner responds 2NT.

Partner's bid shows 13-16 points, balanced. And most importantly, it denies holding a 4-card Major suit. So you do not consider bidding either your ♥s or ♠s, but just bid 3NT.